FIND THE MAIN IDEA SENTENCE

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

One sentence in each paragraph states the main idea; the others give details. It is often the first sentence, but not always. Underline the main idea sentence, then circle its position.

1. Pumpkins are more useful than most people think. Their seeds can be roasted for a crunchy snack. The flesh goes into soups, pies and bread. Even the flowers can be fried and eaten.

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd 4th

2. Some sharks must keep swimming to breathe. Others can rest on the sea floor. A few can even live in rivers. Sharks are more varied than their scary reputation suggests.

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd 4th

3. The bus was late again. The rain had flooded two roads on its route. A tree had fallen across a third. Tuesday morning was a hard day to get to school.

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd 4th

4. Owls hunt at night, when most other birds sleep. Their huge eyes gather the faintest light. Soft feather edges let them fly without a sound. Owls are built for hunting in the dark.

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd 4th

5. Ice cream melts fastest on a windy day. Moving air carries heat to the ice cream faster than still air. Wind also dries the surface, which speeds up melting. That is why a cone drips more at the beach than indoors.

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd 4th

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FIND THE MAIN IDEA SENTENCE

ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

One sentence in each paragraph states the main idea; the others give details. It is often the first sentence, but not always. Underline the main idea sentence, then circle its position.

1. **Pumpkins are more useful than most people think.** Their seeds can be roasted for a crunchy snack. The flesh goes into soups, pies and bread. Even the flowers can be fried and eaten.

Main idea sentence: **1st** 2nd 3rd 4th

2. Some sharks must keep swimming to breathe. Others can rest on the sea floor. A few can even live in rivers. **Sharks are more varied than their scary reputation suggests.**

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd **4th**

3. The bus was late again. The rain had flooded two roads on its route. A tree had fallen across a third. **Tuesday morning was a hard day to get to school.**

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd **4th**

4. Owls hunt at night, when most other birds sleep. Their huge eyes gather the faintest light. Soft feather edges let them fly without a sound. **Owls are built for hunting in the dark.**

Main idea sentence: 1st 2nd 3rd **4th**

5. **Ice cream melts fastest on a windy day.** Moving air carries heat to the ice cream faster than still air. Wind also dries the surface, which speeds up melting. That is why a cone drips more at the beach than indoors.

Main idea sentence: **1st** 2nd 3rd 4th